

CTF Write-up: Travellers – A Beautiful View

Category: OSINT • Points: 496

Challenge Overview

This challenge involved identifying a scenic location from a photograph linked to another member of the “**Travellers**” hacktivist group.

Objective: Determine where the image was taken and identify the nearest cafe to that location.

- **Target:** Third member of the Travellers group
- **Goal:** Identify the nearest cafe
- **Flag Format:** `SK-CERT{Name_of_the_cafe}`

Phase 1: Location Identification

The provided image, `travellers_part3.jpg`, featured a large modern amphitheater illuminated by the setting sun, with mountainous terrain visible in the background.

Key Visual Clues

- Large stone amphitheater structure
- Roman-style stage facade (scaenae frons)
- Arid environment with rolling hills
- Distant mountain range
- Modern recreation of classical theater architecture

The unique architecture and landscape strongly suggested a Middle Eastern location.

After comparing the structure against known landmarks, the location was identified as:

Erbil Amphitheater
Shanadar Park (Minaret Park Area)
Erbil, Iraq

The photographer appeared to be seated at the highest section of the amphitheater (the *summa cavea*), facing south toward the stage and mountains.

Phase 2: Finding the Nearest Cafe

The challenge hinted that the Travellers group members “love coffee,” meaning the next task was identifying the closest cafe to the amphitheater.

Additional satellite imagery provided in:

Lilac cafe.jpg

was used for proximity analysis.

Step 1 — Analyze the Satellite View

The circular structure of the amphitheater was clearly visible near the top of the image.

Step 2 — Trace the Measurement Path

A measurement line extended south/southeast through the wooded park area.

Step 3 — Identify Nearby Businesses

The measurement line terminated near a cafe located directly within the Shanadar Park complex.

Step 4 — Confirm the Cafe Name

Local business listings and geographic markers identified the location as:

Lilac Cafe

Phase 3: Final Verification

- **Proximity:** Lilac Cafe was the closest cafe directly adjacent to the amphitheater area.
- **Accessibility:** The cafe was located inside the same park complex, making it the most logical meeting spot.
- **Consistency:** The challenge progression continued the “Travellers” theme, moving between notable international landmarks.
- **OSINT Logic:** The combination of architecture, terrain, and satellite imagery uniquely confirmed the location.

Final Solution

The nearest cafe to the photographer’s position at the Erbil Amphitheater was determined to be:

SK-CERT{Lilac_Cafe}

Conclusion

This challenge showcased several important OSINT investigation techniques:

- Architectural recognition
- Terrain and environmental analysis
- Satellite imagery interpretation
- Geographic proximity analysis
- Business and landmark verification

Through careful visual investigation and geolocation analysis, the exact cafe nearest to the image location was successfully identified.